# Orgasm Is Safety

Why slow matters, and why relaxation comes before everything else

by Lawrence Lanoff

Excerpted from Beyond the Myth: The Definitive Guide to Modern Tantra, Chapter 10 (The Nature of Orgasm). Free reading copy. For adults (18+). Education, not therapy or medical care.
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## The shape of the arc — and why slow matters

Arousal in the body doesn't climb a straight line. It climbs in waves — peaks and small dips, each rise building toward a higher overall level. Plotted out, it looks like a run of ascending hills, each one a little taller than the last, leading up to the peak that becomes the orgasm. After the peak, the slope drops — steeply for men, more gently for women — back toward where it started.

And the shape of the climb matters enormously.

Sex that goes zero to peak in a few minutes — the standard script, especially for him — only ever climbs the first hill. The body never got to build through the whole sequence. The orgasm at the end of a five-minute arc is, mechanically, the same event as the orgasm at the end of a forty-five-minute one — but the experience of it is a different world. The long arc lets the body drop deeper into open. The breath slows. The body softens. The blood fully fills the erectile tissue. The brain has time to settle into the kind of state where the watcher is already half-loosened before the peak even arrives.

Same nervous-system event. Different magnitude. Different aftermath. Different memory the body keeps.

Most people's experience of sex is like a sneeze. A quick build, a release, a little relief, done. And a sneeze does exactly what a sneeze is for — the body needed it, it clears, it works. But comparing that to the fuller thing is like comparing a sneeze to an opera. Once you've known the complexity of it — the sound, the music, the drama, the whole arc of feeling moving through a body over time — the sneeze is just a sneeze. Just small. Just the first hill, mistaken for the whole range.

This is the load-bearing reason the practices in this book matter at all. Breath, touch, attention — these slow the climb. The slowed climb deepens the orgasm. The deepened orgasm makes for a longer, more complete return of the body to itself. And after enough deep orgasms, the body's whole baseline shifts. The nervous system gets used to living in open more of the time. The default weather of the body changes. You become, slowly, a more open animal — and it stays.

The shorter version: most adults have been having the first-hill orgasm their whole lives. The fifth hill, or the sixth, or the long gentle plateau, or the sustained wave that won't quit — these are

available on the same equipment, in the same body, with one variable: time and attention. Time is the only ingredient most people aren't spending. Time, and attention.

The contemporary version is even simpler: take more time than feels natural. Then more than that. The body was built for the long arc. The culture just trained you to the short one. You can untrain it. It doesn't take long.

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I've watched this be true for decades: for most women, the orgasm works fine on its own. Alone, in her own hand, in her own time, in her own bed — the body comes, and comes well, and comes reliably. The equipment works. It always did. The trouble, when there's trouble, shows up somewhere very specific: it shows up with a partner.

That tells you almost everything. If the body can come alone and can't come with someone, the missing piece was never mechanical. No new technique fixes it. No deeper anatomy lesson fixes it. The missing piece is safety.

Think of the orgasm as the body's deepest yes to safety. It's the parasympathetic flip we walked through in the first chapter — the switch into open, all the way open, the body so unguarded it's willing to drop the running-self and fall through the gap. The body will not do that while any part of it is still standing watch. It can't. The watcher and the orgasm can't both be on at once. So the orgasm is, at its root, a measure of how safe the body feels in this moment, with this person, in this room. Maximum safety is the doorway. The flip happens when nothing is left to guard against.

Which reframes the whole thing, gently. If she's not coming with a partner, the question was never what's wrong with her body. Her body already proved itself — it comes, reliably, every time it's alone. The real question is what would let this body feel safe enough to let go here. That's a kinder question, and it's the true one, and it's answerable. Slow down. Take the clock out of the room. Take the goal out of the room — chasing the orgasm is itself a kind of pressure, and pressure is the opposite of safety. Build the arousal long and unhurried. Let the body learn, slowly, that it can let go here and be met, not dropped. The orgasm follows safety the way water follows the low ground. You don't make it happen. You make it safe, and then you get out of the way.

This is true for every body, not only hers. The man stuck in the quick five-minute release is, underneath, a body that hasn't felt safe enough to take the long road either. The orgasm that arrives fast and shallow and a little anxious is a nervous system that never fully trusted there was time. Safety lengthens the arc for everyone. The deepest orgasms in any body — his, hers, anyone's — arrive when the body has decided, all the way down, that it is safe to disappear for a few seconds. That's the condition. Make the body safe. The rest is built in.

## Where to go next

If this landed, the next step is one of my two short books, written for one reader at a time.

Tantra for Men (eBook), $19.97

Tantra for Women (eBook), $19.97

And when you want the full program, step by step: Tantra X, $197.

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